Achieve!

Food webs

BACKGROUND

habitat (say 'hab-i-tat') – the particular place where a group of living things live

species (say 'spee-seas') – a group of living things that can breed together to produce fertile offspring

Instead of drawing or writing a food chain, we can better show the many relationships between living things in an ecosystem by drawing a food web.

There is often more than one species that eats another in an ecosystem. Food webs are used to describe the diets of animals that have a variety of food sources, and they are also used to show all the relationships between creatures in a particular ecosystem.

☞ **1** Look at the food web pictured and answer the following questions.

a) What eats the frog?

_____

b) What is eaten by the chicken?

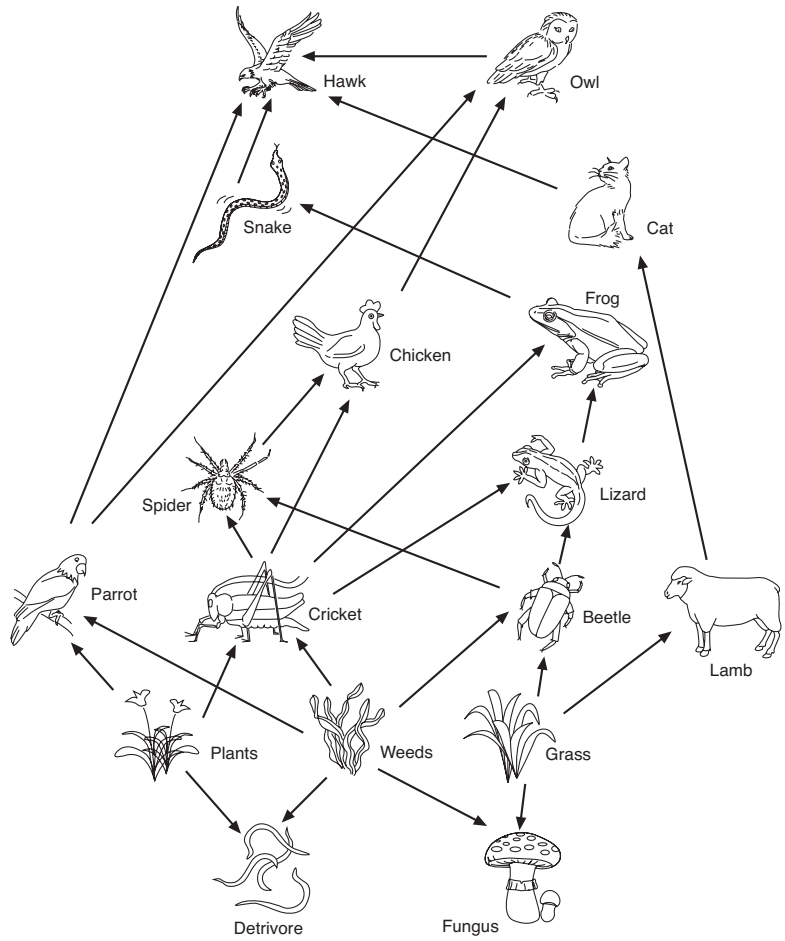
_____

c) What is consumed by the cricket?

_____

d) What kind of ecosystem do you think this food web comes from?

_____



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Food webs CONT'D

2 a) Complete the passage below by writing in the missing words. The words you need are in the letter chain in the box. Separate the words, then write each one into the spaces in order.

foodsourceskillingsmallereggsplantsillnessattack

Some creatures may get their _____ from a variety of _____. This does not always involve _____ prey. For example, a wild dog may kill a _____ animal as one way of getting food. But it may also hunt for _____ in nests, eat _____ or even eat the bodies of animals that died from _____ or from an _____ by another animal.

b) In your workbook, draw a small food web that shows everything that a wild dog eats. Connect each source of food to the wild dog, using arrows.

3 In your workbook, plan and draw a food web for a coral reef. Include the organisms listed in the box below.

Steps to take:

- Make a list of any other living things you wish to include.
- Draw or write food chains to show what eats what.
- Check if there is more than one predator for each type of prey.
- Sketch a plan for your food web before drawing your final version.

plankton	small fish	large fish
sharks	whales	turtles
seaweed	sea slugs	crabs
prawns	sea birds	worms

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